

Page metadata

Meta title: Ensuite Renovations Sydney | Master Suite Specialists | Elite Touch

Meta description: Ensuite bathroom renovations across Sydney — designed for small-footprint master suites, with mechanical ventilation and acoustic detailing done properly. NSW-licensed, family-run.

H1: Ensuite Bathroom Renovations Sydney

Ensuite Bathroom Renovations Sydney

The bathroom you use most, designed for the room it sits inside.

An ensuite is the bathroom you actually use the most. It is the first room you walk into in the morning and the last one you visit before bed. Renovating one is not the same as renovating a main bathroom, the brief is more personal, the privacy and acoustic considerations are higher, the ventilation problem is harder, and the design has to feel continuous with the bedroom it opens off.

What we mean by an ensuite

An ensuite is a bathroom accessed only from a private bedroom, almost always a master. It is distinct from a "main bathroom" (accessed from a hallway, used by the whole household) and a "powder room" (a small toilet-and-basin guest space).

A Sydney ensuite typically serves one or two people regularly and ranges from 3 to 7 square metres in footprint.

Five things that make an ensuite different to a main bathroom

- Footprint. Most Sydney ensuites are 3–7 sqm. The same trades have to deliver the same quality of work in less than half the room. Per-square-metre cost is often higher than a main bathroom because the time on site does not scale linearly with size.
- Ventilation. Most ensuites are internal — no external wall — so natural ventilation through a window is not available. Mechanical ventilation to AS 1668.2 is essential, and getting it right is harder than it looks.
- Acoustic and privacy considerations. The ensuite sits inside the bedroom. Toilet noise, fan noise, plumbing noise — all of it travels into the room your partner is sleeping in.
- Design continuity with the bedroom. The materials and palette should feel like they belong to the same room. An ensuite that fights the bedroom it sits inside feels institutional.
- The shower-or-bath conversation. Ensuites typically skew shower-only. Households tend to keep a bath in the main bathroom and treat the ensuite as the daily-use space.

Ventilation is the part most ensuite renovations get wrong

Because most Sydney ensuites are internal, mechanical extraction is the only way to manage moisture. The National Construction Code Volume Two (Housing Provisions Standards) requires wet-area ventilation, and AS 1668.2 sets the technical performance.

The consequences of getting it wrong are not cosmetic — they migrate into the master bedroom.

Typical signs of a poorly ventilated ensuite are paint peeling on bedroom skirtings, persistent damp smell, mould on bedroom walls adjoining the ensuite wall, and warped timber finishes inside the bedroom itself. Some Sydney homes are also losing mattress life to the moisture migrating overnight.

We design ensuite ventilation around three things:

- Fan capacity matched to room volume and required air-change rate per AS 1668.2
- Duct routing — short, straight runs to external air, ideally not running through bedrooms
- Run-on timers and humidity sensors so the fan extracts after the shower stops, not while you are still in there

Acoustic and privacy detailing

An ensuite is in a different acoustic position to a main bathroom — what happens in one room is heard in the other. We treat acoustics as a design item, not an afterthought:

- Solid-core doors rather than hollow-core, with acoustic seals on the frame and threshold
- Concealed cistern toilets (in-wall) — quieter than close-coupled, and visually quieter too
- Position of the toilet pan relative to the bedhead — we keep them on opposite walls where possible
- Soft-close drawer and door hardware on all joinery
- Insulated walls between ensuite and bedroom where the build allows

Walk-in robe adjacency, when an ensuite project becomes a master-suite project

Many Sydney ensuites share a wall with a walk-in robe. Renovating both together rather than separately opens up real design options: relocating a vanity into the WIR-side of the wall, sharing a wet wall, integrating a vanity-and-dressing-table sequence. If you are renovating an ensuite and the WIR is tired, doing them together is usually the cheaper option, not the more expensive one.

Typical timeline and budget

Sydney ensuite renovations typically run:

- Refresh (same layout, new finishes): 1–2 weeks · \$8,000–\$18,000
- Full renovation (same footprint, new everything): 3–4 weeks · \$20,000–\$40,000
- Reconfigure or WIR-adjacent expansion: 4–6 weeks · \$40,000+

Small does not always mean cheap.

The same number of trades has to fit into the room over the same number of days, and the higher specification of an ensuite (concealed cistern, niche, mirror cabinet, heated rail, premium finishes) often drives the per-square-metre cost above that of a comparable main bathroom.

How we work, what we build to

Every Elite Touch ensuite is delivered to the same compliance framework as a full bathroom:

- Wet-area waterproofing to AS 3740-2021, certified
- Plumbing and drainage to AS/NZS 3500 by a NSW-licensed plumber
- Electrical to AS/NZS 3000 Wiring Rules, including IP-rated fittings where wet-area zoning requires them
- Mechanical ventilation designed to AS 1668.2 and NCC Volume Two

- Frameless shower glass to AS 1288 and AS/NZS 2208
- Slip-resistant floor tiles to AS 4586 and HB 198

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Recent ensuite work

Two of our recent projects demonstrate the ensuite approach in practice:

- Our Hunters Hill marble bathroom case study shows the level of finish and acoustic detailing that translates directly into ensuite work. Read the case study: [\[link to Hunters Hill case study\]](#)
- Our Artarmon case study documents a combined bathroom and ensuite renovation — the ensuite half of that project illustrates how Elite Touch handles dedicated personal wet areas. Read the case study: [\[link to Artarmon case study\]](#)

Frequently asked questions

How small can an ensuite be in Sydney?

Functionally, a one-person ensuite can fit into around 2.5 sqm with careful planning (shower, basin, WC). Most lived-in ensuites are 3–7 sqm. Below 2.5 sqm the room starts to feel like a powder room with a shower bolted on, and the design loses some of what makes an ensuite an ensuite.

Can I add an ensuite to a bedroom that does not have one?

Often yes, depending on whether a walk-in robe or wall can be sacrificed and how plumbing can be routed to and from the new room. We do a feasibility check at the on-site consultation — it is rarely an outright no, but the build complexity and cost depend heavily on plumbing access.

Do ensuites need natural light?

No, but they benefit from it. Most Sydney ensuites are internal and rely on mechanical ventilation plus electric lighting. A skylight, where the roof geometry allows, is the easiest way to bring daylight into an internal ensuite without the privacy compromise of a window.

Should I include a bath in my ensuite?

For most households, no. Most ensuites are too small to carry a bath without compromising the rest of the room, and households tend to use the bath in the main bathroom anyway. Larger ensuites (8 sqm+) can accommodate a freestanding bath if the brief calls for it.

What floor tile is right for an ensuite?

A floor tile with a slip-resistance classification of R10 or higher (per AS 4586) is the safe default for a domestic ensuite. Smaller-format tiles (300×300 mm or mosaics) are easier to fall to a floor waste than large-format tiles, which require flatter substrates. The choice is design-led but constrained by the build.

How loud are ensuite extractor fans?

Good ones are around 0.6–1.0 sones at quiet settings — quieter than the bedroom ceiling fan in most homes. We specify fans by both extraction rate (litres per second) and noise (sones), because a fan that does not stay on after the shower is a fan that has not done its job.

Get a quote

Free on-site measure and fixed-scope written quote for ensuite renovations across Sydney.
Call **[primary contact phone]** **0411752334** or email **[domain-based email]**
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